



OCTOBER 2, 2026

External Advisory Board Meeting



UNIVERSITY OF
ILLINOIS CHICAGO

Today's Agenda

Welcome Advisory Board Members

October 2, 2026	EIB Room 224
12:30pm-1:00pm	Arrival & Check-in
1:00pm-1:05pm	Welcome Remarks Alan Zdunek, Clinical Assoc. Professor & Director of Undergraduate Studies
1:05pm-1:45pm	Graduate Curriculum Update Brian Chaplin, Professor & Director of Graduate Studies
1:45pm-2:30pm	State of the Department Vivek Sharma, Professor & Interim Department Head
2:30pm-2:45pm	UIC Catalyst Center Initiative Meenesh Singh, Professor
2:45pm- 2:55pm	Break
2:55pm-3:45pm	Undergraduate Curriculum Update ABET Review Update EAB/ABET Program Evaluator (PEV) Interview Program Educational Objectives update Alan Zdunek
3:45pm-4:00pm	Action items and Wrap-up

Action Items from last meeting



- **Improving industry/academic liaisons**
 - UIC Catalyst Center update
- **Graduate program improvement**
 - Continuing discussions on MS programs
- **Recruitment and increasing visibility**
 - AIChE student chapter outreach to high schools
- **Revising Mission Statement and Program Educational Objectives**
 - Updated and final versions in progress
- **Additional EAB meeting attendees**
 - Faculty, undergraduate and graduate students
- **Undergraduate program improvements- Ongoing**



Graduate Program Update Professor Brian Chaplin



State of the Department Professor Vivek Sharma



BREAK



Undergraduate Curriculum

Undergraduate Enrollment and Recruitment

Total enrollment Fall 2026: 218 students

- 188 Fall 2025
- 64 new students
 - 45 freshmen (70%)
 - 17 transfers (27%)
 - 2 readmits

Target enrollment for Fall 2027: 250 students

- Promote department and increase visibility
- EPC initiative- Course planning schedule for City Colleges of Chicago transfer students- increase admits
- Restart CHE Yield Sessions with COE recruitment team
- Continue personalized emails/phone calls to applicants/admits
 - **Concern- COE no longer allows emails from department**





ABET Review Update



- Self Study Report submitted to ABET July 1, 2026
- ABET Review Dates: Sunday 11/15- Tuesday 11/17
 - CHE Program Evaluator: Gary Scott SUNY
 - Initial meeting with Gary in August (VS, AZ)
 - Pre-visit questions from PEV
 - **ChE EAB/PEV meeting Monday 11/16**
 - Tentative time- Lunchtime ~40 minutes
 - In-person or remote
- **ABET Presentation System**
 - Additional information to SSR for PEV review: student course output, closing the loop on assessment, meeting files, correspondence
 - Updating system and files

Weblink: https://alzdunek.github.io/abet-presentation_sys/



Revision of the Current ChE Mission Statement and Program Educational Objectives

Previous Mission Statement & PEO'S

“The mission of the Department of Chemical Engineering is to serve society through excellence in education, research, and public service. We provide for our students an education in chemical engineering, and we aspire to instill in them the attitudes, values, and vision that will prepare them for lifetimes of continued learning and leadership in their chosen careers. Through scholarship, the Department strives to generate new knowledge and technology for the benefit of the State of Illinois, the nation, and beyond.”

PEO	Category	Description
1	Depth	In engineering practice, advanced study or original research, UIC Chemical Engineering bachelor's degree graduates will be effective in applying fundamental principles, scientific knowledge, rigorous analysis, creative design, and conceptual innovation.
2	Breadth	Based upon mastery of engineering in a broad, societal context, UIC Chemical Engineering graduates will have successful careers in the public or private sectors, or in the pursuit of graduate education.
3	Professionalism and Service	In the service of industry, government, the engineering profession and society at large, graduates will function effectively in the complex modern work environment with clear communication, responsible teamwork, and high standards of ethics, professionalism, safety and protection of the environment.
4	Life-Long Learning and Leadership	Based upon a rigorous undergraduate program that is innovative, challenging, open and supportive, graduates will enhance their skills and knowledge through life-long learning and demonstrate professional leadership.



REVISION PROCESS

- **FACULTY REVIEW:
NEW STATEMENT AND
PEO'S PROPOSED**
- **EAB REVIEW:
FEEDBACK AND
REVISIONS**
- **ALUMNI SURVEY:
FEEDBACK/REVISIONS**
- **STUDENT SURVEY:
FEEDBACK/REVISIONS**

Proposed Mission Statement & PEO'S

“The mission of the Department of Chemical Engineering is to deliver an outstanding and accessible education to a diverse student body. We prepare skilled engineers to advance both fundamental and applied research, drive innovation, and lead the development of transformative technologies that enhance economic/upward mobility and contribute to local and global prosperity”.

PEO	Category	Description
1	Professional Impact	Apply fundamental principles, scientific and engineering knowledge, problem-solving, critical thinking, and creative design to <u>drive tangible impact in chemical</u> engineering practice and non-engineering fields such as law, medicine, education and business.
2	Professional Practice	Contribute to industry, academia, government and entrepreneurial ventures and develop innovative, <u>sustainable</u> solutions that address societal and technical challenges locally and globally, contributing to economic growth and upward mobility.
3	Service and Leadership	Practice engineering with clear communication, leadership, teamwork, and high standards of integrity, ethical responsibility, <u>with focus on safety of human life and</u> protection of the environment, thereby creating a collaborative, diverse and inclusive culture in the workplace.
4	Professional Development	Reinforce skills and knowledge through graduate education, professional development courses, self-directed research, and on-the-job training and experience.



Discussion and Wrap-Up

Next Meeting: Fall 2027